

United Healthcare Prior Authorization
Clinical Criteria for Advanced Cardiac Imaging

Parameter	Policy Specification
Payer Name	United Healthcare Gold Plus
CPT Code	75563
Procedure Name	Cardiac MRI with Contrast
Plan Type	Commercial PPO
Department	Prior Authorization Clinical Review
Status	Active

POLICY PURPOSE STATEMENT

This policy establishes the prior authorization clinical criteria for Cardiac MRI with Contrast (CPT 75563) under United Healthcare Gold Plus plans. All requests must meet the criteria outlined in this document prior to service delivery.

CLINICAL INDICATIONS FOR APPROVAL

Approval for Cardiac MRI with Contrast (CPT 75563) is subject to clinical necessity review. The following criteria **MUST ALL** be met for approval:

Criterion 1 — Diagnosis Requirement:

Patient must have a confirmed diagnosis of one of the following conditions:

- Dilated Cardiomyopathy (ICD-10: I42.0)
- Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy (ICD-10: I42.1)
- Restrictive Cardiomyopathy (ICD-10: I42.5)
- Cardiac Sarcoidosis (ICD-10: D86.85)
- Suspected Cardiac Tumor or Mass

Criterion 2 — Symptom Duration:

Symptoms must be present and documented for a minimum period of 3 months including:

- Shortness of breath on exertion
- Chest pain or pressure
- Palpitations or arrhythmia
- Unexplained syncope or near-syncope
- Reduced exercise tolerance

Criterion 3 — Prior Testing Requirement:

Patient must have completed echocardiogram prior to MRI request. Echocardiogram must show:

- LVEF (Left Ventricular Ejection Fraction) documented value
- Evidence of wall motion abnormality or
- Structural cardiac abnormality requiring further characterization

Criterion 4 — Physician Requirement:

Request must be ordered by a board-certified Cardiologist or Cardiac Electrophysiologist.

REQUIRED DOCUMENTS FOR PRIOR AUTHORIZATION SUBMISSION

Submission of the following documentation is mandatory. Incomplete files will result in a delay in processing or a technical denial.

No.	Document Name	Description	Format Accepted
1	Clinical Justification Note	Detailed note from treating Cardiologist explaining medical necessity. Must include: patient history, current symptoms, previous treatments tried, reason echocardiogram is insufficient. Must be signed and dated.	PDF or DOCX
2	Echocardiogram Report	Most recent echocardiogram report within last 12 months. Must document LVEF value, chamber dimensions, wall motion analysis, and valve function.	PDF or Image
3	Recent Lab Results	Laboratory results within last 30 days including: BNP or NT-proBNP levels, complete metabolic panel, complete blood count.	PDF or Image
4	Physician Order Letter	Official order on physician letterhead signed by referring Cardiologist. Must include: procedure requested, ICD-10 diagnosis code, clinical indication, physician NPI number.	PDF or DOCX
5	Prior Treatment Records	Documentation of cardiac medications tried for minimum 3 months including drug names, dosages, duration of therapy, and patient response or reason for discontinuation.	PDF or DOCX

COVERAGE CRITERIA AND EXCLUSIONS

Coverage Includes:

- Cardiac MRI when echocardiogram findings are inconclusive
- Assessment of myocardial viability
- Evaluation of cardiac masses or tumors
- Assessment of pericardial disease
- Congenital heart disease evaluation

Not Covered Under This Policy:

- Screening cardiac MRI without clinical indication
- Repeat MRI within 6 months without new symptoms
- MRI ordered without prior echocardiogram attempt
- Requests from non-cardiology specialties without cardiology consultation

AUTHORIZATION VALIDITY

The following administrative rules apply to all issued authorizations:

- Approved authorization is valid for a period of **90 calendar days** from the date of issuance.
- Authorization is limited to a **single (1) procedure** per approval.
- Reauthorization is required if the procedure is not completed within the initial validity period.
- Authorization does not guarantee payment; the member must be active on the date of service.

SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

To ensure timely review, please use one of the following official submission methods:

Method	Details
Online Portal	UHCprovider.com/priorauth
Phone	1-866-889-8054
Fax	1-855-820-4189
EDI	Transaction Set 278

REVIEW TIMELINE

Request Type	Decision Timeframe
Standard Pre-Service	3 to 5 business days
Urgent Pre-Service	24 to 72 hours
Concurrent Review	1 business day
Retrospective	30 calendar days

IMPORTANT NOTES

- Submit **ALL** required documents at time of request to avoid administrative delays.
- Incomplete submissions will be returned without clinical review.
- Additional information requests (RFI) will be sent via portal/fax within 2 business days.
- Peer-to-peer review is available within 2 business days of an adverse determination.